16

PATTERN MAKING

16.1 INTRODUCTION

Cutting the cloth for sewing is an art in itself. The entire sewing and fitting of the garment depend upon cutting. In order to make a good dress, first a pattern is cut on which the design is set to see the final effect. Before cutting the cloth, the different parts of the garment are cut on paper and set aside. There are then used to conveniently cut the cloth later on. A drafting is made according to body measurements and then the paper pattern is made. The pattern has to be good in order to get a good fitting. One also needs to have knowledge of the different types of patterns, how and where they are used, etc.

16.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- make a pattern correctly;
- use different types of pattern;
- demonstrate the methods of making patterns;

16.3 BASIC PATTERN

The drafting is made on paper and then cut to make a pattern. This paper pattern is carefully inspected before cutting the cloth. The paper pattern is made exactly according to the measurement and the style of the garment. This is why the paper pattern is called the prototype of the garment. It is essential to have a correct pattern. A paper pattern is

called a tailor's friend.

Pattern can be made in two ways -

i) The final pattern is made directly with the body measurements.

ii) The final pattern is made after adjusting the design according to fashion on the basic pattern made with the body measurements.

The pattern for ordinary clothes is made by the first method. The second method is used for making patterns for fashionable dresses and in factories. A pattern should be carefully put away for future use and for adapting according to fashion.

There are three ways of storing patterns -

1. Individual patterns are stored in shops. The are stored by listing the customers according to garments made or according to address. The listing may also be done on the basis of gender - make/female and child.

2. Every factory has its own system of storing the patterns. They may be stored according to dress size or according to fashion. Here, too, the pattern are listed.

3. While storing patterns one must know the procedure used in making it. The method of garment construction can be selected later on.

4. Patterns made of hardboard, plastic or fibre are stored either by hanging or kept flat. Patterns made of flimsy paper are kept folded or rolled up.

5. Patterns should be treated against insects/worms.

A good quality and durable paper should be used for making patterns. Cardboard, plastic or fibre can be used for making the basic block or master pattern. The pattern should be made according to the drafting and all the measurements should be noted on it. The pattern should be cut along the lines only after checking the measurements. After cutting the pattern should be carefully stored.

Marking of pattern

It is important to place some markings on a pattern during clothing construction. It is important to know these markings. They are -

1. Joint

This indicates the joining of different parts like front to back, sleeve to body, cuff to sleeve, collar, yoke, etc.

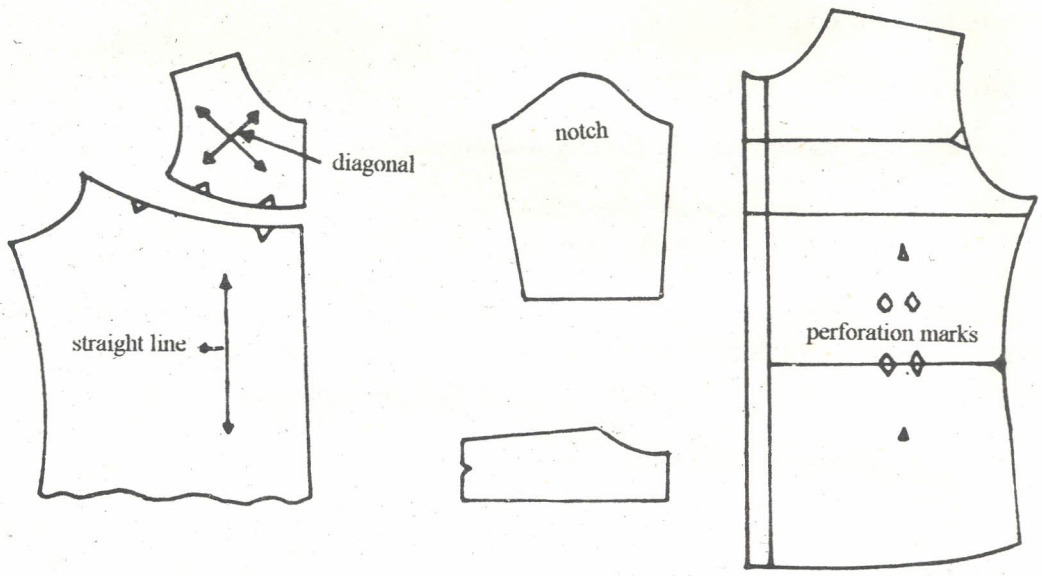


Fig 16.1 Markings on pattern

2. Place

The place where darts, gathers, pleats, pockets, etc. are to be placed have to be marked on the pattern.

3. Fashion features

New styles have to be developed according to the prevalent fashion in order to make the dress attractive. These are also indicated on the pattern, e.g. frills, embroidery or smocking.

4. Direction

The lengthwise direction of a garment lies along the weft of the fabric. This may change according to fashion and is always indicated on the pattern.

5. Procedure

This information is indicated by special marks such as -

line - the body lines such as waist, chest/bust, seat, bottom, etc. are indicted by lines.

6. Arrows

These are used to indicate the direction such as lengthwise, widthwise or bias.

7. Notches

Small cuts in the shape of 'V' are made on the edge of the pattern and cloth. These

are made only at the edges and are generally used to indicate the point of joining, seam allowance, turning, etc.

8. Perforation

Any marking to be made on the cloth, is known as style feature on the pattern. This is indicated by making small holes called perforation marks on the pattern. These are diamond shaped. The placement of darts, pockets, etc. is indicated in this manner. These marks are used only on paper patterns.

Making new pattern in designs according to the fashion is known as creative pattern or pattern construction. For example - placing yoke on shirts, creating new styles, etc.

INTEXT QUESTIONS 16.1

State whether the following statement are true or false -

a) Pattern can be made by two methods.

b) The style or design can be made ont he cloth without using a pattern.

c) Pattern is made only one paper.

d) Notches are made only on the pattern.

e) Pattern can not be reused.

16.4 TYPES OF PAPER PATTERN

Patterns are of various kinds as given below -

1. Ordinary pattern
2. Individual pattern
3. Readymade pattern
4. Final pattern
5. Block pattern
6. Trade block
7. Block pattern layout
8. Graded pattern
9. Fitting pattern

1. Ordinary pattern

Any pattern cut on paper is known as ordinary pattern. When the measurements of many people are taken and a pattern is made according to the average measurements, the pattern is called standard pattern. Whether the pattern is made according to average measurements or individual measurements, it is an ordinary pattern.

2. Individual pattern

The pattern made according to a particular individuals measurements is known as individual pattern. The style or design are also set according to the individual's taste.

3. Readymade pattern

These are available only in foreign countries where big companies do not accept small order. The women there know how to sew but not how to cut the clothes. Hence, they make use of readymade patterns available in the market. These can be bought in various sizes and have the measurements and the pattern layout depicted along with detailed instructions.

4. Final pattern

The final pattern is the one used to cut the cloth and is error free. This pattern shows the seam allowances, turning, etc. The final pattern is made with the help of the basic pattern. When garments are made on a large scale in factories, the cloth estimation is done with the help of the final pattern.

5. Block pattern

The final pattern is usually cut on chart paper or plywood in factories where garments are made on as large scale. These are durable and can easily be stored.

6. Trade block

When a block is made for a particular fashionable dress with the objective of large scale production, it is called a trade block.

7. Block pattern layout

A layout of the block pattern is made on a chart paper whose width equals the width of the cloth. The outlines of the blocks are perforated with a needle. This chart paper is placed over the cloth which is spread flat on a table. Then China

clay is spread over the perforated outlines and in this way the outlines are transferred to the cloth. The cutter in the factory then cuts along these lines.

8. Graded pattern

When different sizes are marked on the same pattern, it is called a graded pattern. For example, a pattern may have sizes 32", 34", 36" marked on it. There is a difference of 2" between each size. The size to be made is selected and the marking of that size are transferred to the cloth for cutting. In this way time and effort can be saved by marking different sizes on the same pattern.

9. Fitting Pattern

This is generally used for cutting ready made garments. These are available in sizes like 32", 34", 36", in the market. These are made of cardboard and can be used for a long time.

16.5 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the type of paper pattern, the method of making a paper pattern and the correct method of storing patterns. You have also learnt about the different types of patterns.

Do and see

i) Establish the difference between notches and perforations.

ii) Distinguish between block pattern and graded pattern.

16.6 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. How many types of patterns are there? Describe in detail how a creative pattern is made.

16.7 ANSWER TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

16.1 (a) True (b) False (c) False

(d) False (e) False